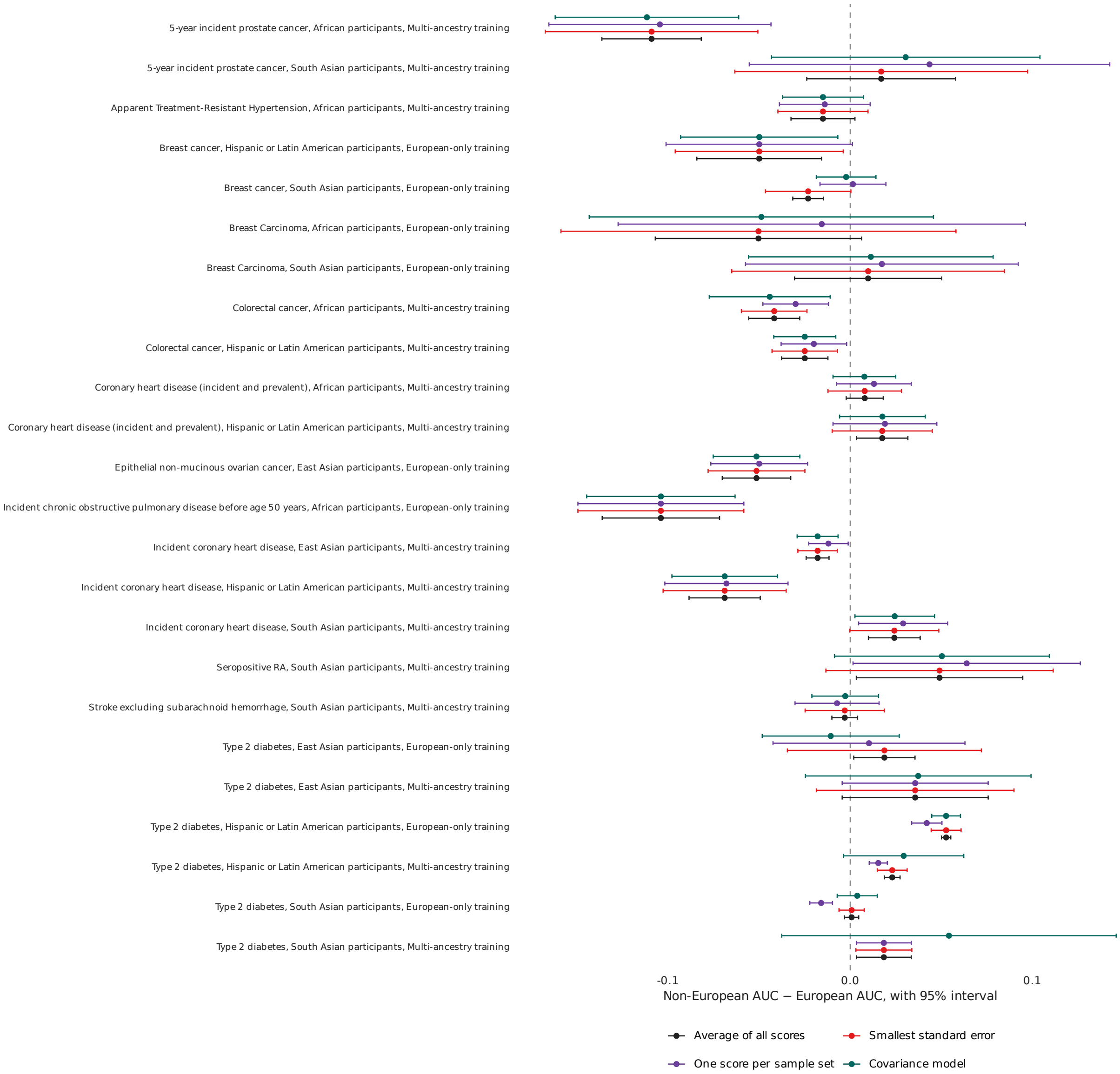
11. Earlier checks beside the covariance model

The 24 comparisons whose scores share people.



The smallest standard error keeps the plain average and uses the smallest score standard error as its standard error. That is roughly the plain average's own standard error if every error were perfectly correlated and the plain-average weights were kept. It is not the refit at $\rho = 1$.

As ρ approaches 1, V becomes nearly singular. The fit can use differences between highly correlated scores to cancel error, so the interval can shrink and the weights can go extreme.

Two comparisons already narrow as ρ rises: Type 2 diabetes, East Asian participants, European-only training; and Type 2 diabetes, Hispanic or Latin American participants, Multi-ancestry training. Figure 9 points here for the first. At $\rho = 0.9$ its estimate has changed sign and excludes zero on the other side. That is extreme weights, not stronger evidence.

The sample-set term is a different model and is not drawn.